INCH POUND
A-A-20158C
May 21, 2004
SUPERSEDING
A-A-20158B
July 22, 1993

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
SALMON, CANNED OR FLEXIBLE POUCH

The U.S. Department of Agriculture has authorized the use of this Commercial. Item Description in preference to Federal Specification PP-S-31F and Product Purchase Description PPD-05-S-003E.

This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers canned/pouch salmon, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by the Federal Government.

Salient characteristics

The canned or flexible pouch salmon shall conform to one or more of the following species, styles, and salt/sodium levels as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order. Canned salmon (and pouch salmon as applicable) shall meet the requirements of 21 CFR Part 161.170.

Species.

Oncorhynchus tshawytscha - Chinook, king, spring
Oncorhynchus nerka - Blueback, red, sockeye
Oncorhynchus kisutch - Coho, medium red, silver
Oncorhynchus gorbuscha - Pink
Oncorhynchus keta - Chum, keta

Styles

Style I - Regular - skin and bones included
Style II - Special - skinless and backbone removed
Style III – Pouch – skinless and boneless

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc., and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: Technical Services Branch, Seafood Inspection Program, NOAA – Fisheries, U.S. Department of Commerce, Room 10874, 1315 East-West Highway, Silver Spring, MD 20910

FSC 8905/8940

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Salt/Sodium levels.

Level a - Regular (no more than 1.5 percent salt.)
Level b - No salt added (no sodium, chloride added during processing)
Level c - Very low sodium (35 milligrams or less sodium per serving)
Level d - Low sodium (140 milligrams or less sodium per serving)

Processing.

Only current season, fresh or RSW (Refrigerated Sea Water) unintentionally partially frozen salmon shall be used for canned product. Current season fresh or frozen salmon shall be used for pouch product. The product shall be derived from raw material having characteristics that are indicative of good quality salmon. These include, but are not limited to, firmness and color of flesh typical of the species, and no off-odor of the gills and gut cavity. The washed salmon shall be free of objectionable materials, including but not limited to, heads, gills, tails, viscera, blood marks, bruising, collar cartilage and fins.

In addition to the above, pouch salmon shall be free of rib bones and vertebrae. The salmon fillets shall be deep skinned and boneless and packaged in a laminated 4-pound pouch. Salmon trim, derived from the same fillet production day and derived from deep skinned fillets, may be included at a level not to exceed 8 percent by weight as packaged. Pouch salmon shall contain spices, seasonings, artificial colors, and other ingredients as needed to produce a consistent flavor, texture and odor. Pouch salmon shall contain no monosodium glutamate.

Watermarked salmon shall not be used.

Hatchery brood carcasses shall not be used.

The salmon and oil shall conform to the following product characteristics:

TABLE I. Product characteristics

Species	Color of oil	Color of flesh	Texture of fish
Chinook, king, spring	Light red through orange to almost white	Red to orange red to light pink	Moderately firm to soft
Blueback, red, sockeye	Deep red to deep orange	Dark red to orange red	Moderately firm to soft
Coho, medium red, silver	Light red to yellowish pink	Red to orange red to light pink	Moderately firm to soft
Pink	Pink to light yellow	Pink to Light Pink	Moderately firm to slightly soft (but not mushy)
Chum, keta	Light pink with orange shade to yellow	Light pink to grayish white	Moderately firm to firm

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Analytical requirements.

Chemical analyses shall be made in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International.

Test	Chapter, Number and Title	Official Method Numbers
Salt	35, Fish and Other Marine Products	**937.09** Salt (Chlorine as Sodium Chloride) in Seafood **976.18** Salt (Chlorine as Sodium Chloride) in Seafood **976.19** Salt (Chlorine as Sodium Chloride) in Seafood
Sodium	35, Fish and Other Marine Products	**969.23** Sodium and Potassium in Seafood

Contractor's certification.

By submitting an offer, the contractor certifies that the product offered meets the specified salient characteristics and requirements of this CID: conforms to the producers own specifications and standards, including product characteristics, manufacturing procedures, quality control procedures, and storage and handling practices; has a national or regional distribution from storage facilities located within the United States, its territories, or possessions; and is available and sold to the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to determine proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery from point of origin and any time thereafter, up to and including delivery at final destination, as may be necessary to determine conformance with the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

The delivered product shall comply with all applicable Federal and State mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, processing, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sales of the product within the commercial marketplace. Delivered product shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated there under. Delivered product shall also meet with the provisions of Regulations found in CFR 50, Subchapter G- Processed Fishery Products, Processed Products Thereof, and Certain Other Processed Food Products, Part 260, Inspection and Certification.

Quality assurance.

Compliance with this CID shall be determined by the U.S. Department of Commerce (USDC), Seafood Inspection Program (SIP). USDC/SIP will determine the degree of inspection and supervision necessary to assure specification compliance.

The cost of all services performed by USDC/SIP agents involving examination, supervision, official documentation, and related services shall be borne by the contractor.

The canned or pouch salmon shall be inspected by USDC, SIP, under Type I continuous inspection or Type II lot inspection in accordance with this CID and contract requirements.

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External examination for condition of containers will be conducted using the U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers (7 GFR Part 42) and Performance Specification Packaging of Food in Flexible Pouches, MIL-PRF-44073F.

In MIL-PRF-44073F, paragraph 4.2, Examination of pouches, use Table II & Table III and all footnotes. Sampling Plan use ANSI/ASQ Z1.4- 2003.

Table	Inspection Level 1/	AQL	
II	II	Major A	1.0
		Major B	2.5
		Minor	4.0
III		Major	2.5
		Minor	4.0

NOTE: One Critical defect rejects the entire lot.

Paragraph 4.3.8, Commercial Sterility will be certified by a Certificate of Compliance.

Internal examination for condition of containers shall be in accordance with USDC/SIP policies and procedures. Assurance of can or pouch requirements may be based on the acceptance of a certificate of conformance.

Sampling for inspection and determination of acceptability shall be done in accordance with provisions as set forth in the American National Standard, ANSI/ASQC Z1.4 – 2003. Defects found during inspection shall be classified in accordance with Tables II through IX of the CID at the inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) as shown below.
AQL's shall be expressed in defects per hundred units. The lot size shall be expressed in cans or pouches.

TABLE II. Inspection levels and acceptance numbers

Table	Inspection Level 1/	AQL	
III	S3	Major	Minor
IV (Canned Only)	S3	-----	6.5
V (Canned Only)	S3	-----	6.5
VI	S3	-----	10.0
VII	S3	1.5	6.5
VIII (Canned Only)	S2	1.5	6.5

1/ Sample shipping containers shall be selected randomly on a proportionate basis from not less than 90 percent of the codes listed in a lot or on the warehouse receipts. In the event that the referenced inspection levels result in a sample size that is too small to provide for sampling 90 percent of the codes in a lot or on the warehouse receipts a level sufficiently large enough to accommodate this requirement shall be selected. Not more than one primary container per shipping container shall be examined for the defects within the tables listed in Table II.

The sample unit for USDC/SIP inspection is the contents of one can or pouch. For sampling purposes, the maximum lot size will be the quantity of product produced on a single line during an 8-hour production shift. The USDC/SIP inspector if necessary may reduce the lot size. If a plant operates two or more lines under inspection simultaneously, the products from each line will he inspected as separate lots. Also if a plant wishes to extend the processing day beyond a

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normal 8-hour shift, the product produced after the ends of the 8-hour shift will be inspected as a new lot. For labeling and identification purposes, production lots shall be numbered in sequence.

For purposes of lot identification, in addition to the requirements contained in 21 CFR Part 113, a code change will be necessary when a shift concludes or a new shift begins.

For Type II lot inspected product, a lot will consist of all codes from a single line produced during a normal 8-hour shift.

For Type I continuous inspection any facility which operates more than one line under inspection may require an inspector for each line. This is to enable the inspector to have sufficient time to perform a sanitation inspection, examination for product characteristics, condition of container examination, etc., and still have sufficient time to observe the materials being processed to ensure their suitability for processing.

The contractor shall obtain a USDC/SIP Certificate of Inspection which state(s) the product meets all requirements of this CID.

TABLE III Examination for net weights 1/ 2/ 3/

Category	Defect
Minor	
201	A single primary container with more than 5 percent under specified weight.

1/ Failure of lot average net weight to meet specified net weight shall be basis for rejection of entire lot.

2/ Report results to the nearest 0.1 ounce (2.835 g).

3/ Net weight for pouch product will be determined as follows:

Weigh sealed pouch.
Empty the contents into tray.
Clean and dry the pouch.
Weigh the empty pouch.
Deduct the weight of the empty pouch from the weight of the sealed pouch and record as net weight.

TABLE IV. Examination for vacuum requirements (Canned product only)

Category	Defect
Minor	
201	Vacuum less than 5 inches (12.7 cm).

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TABLE V. Examination of cross fill (Canned Product Only)

Category	Defect
Minor	
201	Cross fill. 1/

1/ The vertebral column not generally parallel to the vertical axis of the can.

TABLE VI. Examination of pieces and patches

Category	Defect
Minor	
201	Pink salmon only. More than 4 pieces and 1 patch in cans less than or equal to 16 ounces (453.59 g). More than 12 pieces and 1 patch in 64-ounce cans (l814.37 g). 1/ All other canned salmon. More than 3 pieces and 1 patch in cans less than or equal to 16 ounces (453.59 g). More than 12 pieces and 1 patch in 64-ounce cans (1,814.37 g). 1/ Pouched salmon containing more than 8 percent by weight, as packaged, of salmon trim. 2/

1/ A patch is a small portion of salmon which is added, if necessary, to complete the fill of the container. A patch is any small portion less than 1 ounce (28.35 g).

2/ Salmon trim must be from the same fillet production date as product being packed and be derived from deep skinned fillets only.

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TABLE VII. Product defects

Category			Defect
Critical	Major	Minor	
1			Flesh showing evidence of true honeycombing or the presence of flavors and/or odors of decomposition such as, but not limited to, sour and rancid. 1/ 2/
	101		Presence of objectionable flavors or odors such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, overcooked, stale, other objectionable flavors, odors, or flavors and odors of watermarking (hominy, muddy). 3/
	102		Presence of objectionable foreign material, such as, but not limited to, rust, wood, hair, dirt, or insect or insect parts either singly or in combination. 4/
	103		Bones hard, not, soft and friable. 5/
	104		Species of salmon not as specified.
	105		Presence of struvite crystals
	106		Evidence of Freezing and/or slacking (thawing) as indicated by the presence of more than a moderate amount of curd or other factors.
	107		Pouch salmon not produced from deep skinned salmon fillets (Style III only)
		201	Presence of watermarking indicated by the color change of the normal white area (i.e. belly) to another color characteristic of the species (Style I only).
		202	Presence of gills, fins, or viscera.
		203	Color of flesh not pink to light pink.
		204	Color of oil not characteristic of species.
		205	Texture of fish not firm to slightly soft.
		206	Presence of skin and backbone (Style II only). 6/
		207	Presence of skin (not deep skinned) or bone Style III only).
		208	Presence of blood clots, mutilated areas, or bruises. 7/
		209	Sulfide blackening.

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TABLE VII. Product defects (continued)

1/ These are regarded as critical defects and their finding will be basis for rejection of the entire lot.

2/ Honeycombing is the visible appearance of discrete holes or openings of varying size observed in the salmon flesh.

3/ Do not include flavors and odors of decomposition.

4/ Presence of chemicals, glass, or metal particles, animal excreta, or similar extraneous material which could harmfully affect or contaminate the product (critical defects) shall be basis for rejection of the entire lot.

5/ Hard bones are those which are not soft or friable. Bones are soft and friable if the vertebrae are easily crushed when pressed between thumb and fingers. Bones should be brittle and breakable with slight distorting finger pressure. Thermal processing records should be carefully reviewed and process authorities will be consulted if necessary.

6/ Minor 206 is a defect if the skin and backbone is not removed in accordance with good manufacturing practices. If the majority of sample units are defects, the lot may be relabeled as Style 1.

7/ Mutilated areas are areas of flesh which are not physically intact due to mechanical or predatory damage. Blood clots or bruises are those, which detract from the appearance of the product. Minute blood streaks or blood spots that do not materially affect the appearance are not, a defect.

TABLE VIII. Can interior enamel coating defects (Canned Product Only)

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Missing enamel coating.
102		Blistered or softened enamel coating, which can be peeled by fingertip (not fingernail abrasion).
103		Enamel coating with internal rust stains.
	201	Enamel coating with bare areas (other than scratches). 1/
	202	Enamel coating that is dirty, stained, or smeared with foreign material.

1/ A line of solder along the side seam shall not be considered a defect.

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Testing for salt content or sodium content.

The composite for testing for salt content or sodium content shall be a composite of 24 ounces (680.39 g) of product. The minimum number of sample units to use for deriving the composite for salt or sodium content is eight sample units. The sample units shall represent all the codes selected for product evaluation. Equal amounts of product will be taken from each selected sample unit and from each code. If the sample size is too small to provide for sampling all codes, more sample units may be selected with less product taken from each can.

At least two tests from a composite sample shall be performed and the results averaged. Results of testing shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent.

Failure to meet salt/sodium levels specified in the contract or CID shall be basis for rejection of the entire lot.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking.

The canned salmon shall be preserved, packaged, packed, labeled, and cases marked in accordance with good commercial practice. Can codes shall appear on the outside of the master case. Commercial labeling and packaging, as may be augmented by the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, shall be acceptable. Shipping containers shall be a minimum of 275 pounds (124.74 kg) bursting strength.

Eight, 43 oz hermetically sealed pouches (or as specified by contract) of salmon shall be processed, packaged, packed, labeled and cases marked in accordance with good commercial practice accept that metal and paper coated wire ties shall not be used to close the bags. Staples shall not be used for closing the box. Shipping containers shall have a minimum of 250-psi bursting strength and/or edge crush test of 40 pounds per inch. Only one style and size of container shall be offered in an individual shipping unit. The pouches shall be suitably code marked so that the product can be identified as part of a specific lot.

Both canned and pouch salmon shall have only one code within each shipping container except as needed to accommodate consecutive changeover periods within a lot. Can or pouch codes and date of pack shall appear on the outside of the master container. Shipping containers shall comply with the National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification, as applicable.

Unless otherwise specified in the Invitation, all truck, rail, and piggyback shipments of product shall be unitized by stacking the shipping containers on pallets. The shipping containers shall be held firmly in place by applying plastic stretch wrap as tightly as possible around all of the tiers stacked on the pallet. Pallet loads shall he stacked in a manner that minimizes the overhang of the shipping containers over the edges of the pallets and exposes the principle shipping container display panel to facilitate acceptance examinations.

At the time of shipment, the USDC/SIP agent shall examine each pallet to ensure that the shipping containers are field firmly in place, and that the appropriate pallets were used. If any noncomplying pallet or stretch wrapping is observed, the units must be reworked and reoffered for inspection.

All trailers used for the shipping of finished product, to its final destination, shall be examined prior to loading to assure the containers are clean, without holes that would allow the entrance of rain or snow and with no evidence that the conveyance has been used to haul hazardous materials or garbage.

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For Department of Defense procurements (Only)

TABLE IX. Packaging and packing requirements for can only.

Style	Salt/Sodium Level	Can Size	Net Weight (ozs)	No. cans per case
I, II OR III	a	301X408	14.75	24
	a	301X408	14.75	48
	a	602X408	64.00	6

Packaging and packing requirements for pouch only

Style	Salt/Sodium Level	Can Size	Net Weight (ozs)	No. per case
I, II OR III	a	n/a	43	8

The following requirements are applicable when specified by the contracting officer.

A. Commercial packaging. The product shall be packaged in a metal can/pouch in accordance with Table IX and good commercial practice.

B. Commercial packing. The number of cans/pouches specified in Table IX shall be packed in fiberboard boxes complying with Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification.

C. Export packing. (cans only) The product shall be packaged in a metal can in accordance with Table IX and with the following requirements: Tinplated cans shall be made from not less than 0.20 pound per base box electrolytic tinplate. The entire inside area of the can shall be enameled. Can ends may be fabricated from FCCS plate, enameled inside and out. Two-piece cans are acceptable. Easy-open features are not acceptable.

D. Export packing (Pouch only). The number of pouches specified in Table IX shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box constructed, closed, and reinforced in accordance with Style RSC, Grade V3c, V3s, or V4s of ASTM-D-1975, and ASTM-D-5l 18. Pouches shall be separated with a full length and width fiberboard pad made of the same material as the box. Reinforcement shall be restricted to nonmetallic strapping or pressure-sensitive adhesive, filament-reinforced tape in accordance with the appendix of ASTM-D-1975, & ASTM-D-5118.

F. Unit loads (commercial and export). Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with DSCP Form 3507. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall he limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for Type II, Class F loads.

F. Labeling (commercial and export). Commercial labeling shall be acceptable.

C. Marking (commercial and export). Marking of shipping containers and unit loads shall be in accordance with DSCP Form 3556.

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Notes.

Purchasers should specify:

- Style
- Salt/Sodium level
- Can /pouch and case size
- Labeling, packaging, and casing requirements if different from commercial practice.

Source of documents:

Sources of information for nongovernmental documents are as follows:

Copies of the National Motor Freight Classification may be obtained from:

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, inc., Agent
National Motor Freight Classification
American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department
2200 Mill Road, Alexandria, VA 22314

Copies of the Uniform Freight Classification may be obtained from:

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent
Uniform Freight Classification
Uniform Classification Committee, Suite 1120
222 South Riverside Plaza
Chicago, II. 60606

Copies of the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International may be obtained from:

AOAC International, Suite 500
481 N. Frederick Ave.
Gaithersburg, MD 20877-2417

Copies of the American Society for Testing & Materials may be obtained from:

ASTM International
100 Hair Harbor Drive
P.O. Box C700
West Conshohocken, PA 19428-2959
(610) 832-9585 or www.astm.org.

Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic are contained in 21 CFR parts 1-199. This three-volume set maybe purchased from:

Superintendent of Documents
U.S. Government Printing Office
Washington, DC 20402-0001

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Credit card (Master Charge or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents on (202) 783-3238.

Copies of the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers are available from:

Chairperson
Condition of Container Committee
Agricultural Marketing Service
U.S. Department of Agriculture
Room 2506, South Building
P.O. Box 96456
Washington, DC 20090-6456

Copies of the Regulations Governing Processed Fishery Products are available from:

Seafood Inspection Program
NOAA - Fisheries
U.S. Department of Commerce
Room 10874
1315 East-West Highway SSMC 3
Silver Spring, MD 20910

Copies of DSCP Forms maybe obtained from:
Commander,
Defense Supply Center Philadelphia
ATTN: DSCP-HXL.
700 Robbins Ave.
Philadelphia, PA. 19111
(215) 737-7772 or
www.dscp.dla.mil/subs/proserv/contref/dscpform.htrn

Civil agencies and other interested parties may obtain copies of this CID from:

General Service Administration
Specifications Unit (3FB-WS)
Room 6654
7th and D Streets, SW
Washington, DC 20407

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID) to:

Standardization Documents Order Desk
Building 4, Section I)
700 Robbins Ave.
Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity:

Army - GL

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - FDA, NIH
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review Activities:
Army - MD, TS
Navy - MC
DLA - SS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

COM - NMF

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